

AI Assurance Governance Board Charter

Authority, membership, and decision rights for the enterprise AI T&E capability

August 2026

AI Assurance Governance Board Charter

Status: DRAFT. Pending signature by the sponsoring executive and formal seating of the Board, per the [Implementation Plan](#)’s Governance Stand-Up milestone (Weeks 1-4).

Purpose

The AI Assurance Governance Board (“the Board”) is the standing body responsible for the standards, risk tiers, and certification policy that make the [Enterprise AI Test, Evaluation & Assurance Strategy](#) one governed capability rather than a collection of per-team practices. The Board exists so that “is this AI system ready to deploy” has one answer, evaluated the same way, regardless of which team built the system.

Authority

The Board:

- **Sets** standards, the risk-tier model, the metric catalog, and the certification process (see the [T&E Policy](#)).
- **Ratifies** the [Enterprise Capability Taxonomy](#) and any subsequent revision to it.
- **Reviews** evaluation evidence for Tier 1-2 systems and issues a readiness recommendation.
- **Does not run evaluations itself.** Evaluation execution stays with domain teams (Benchmark Engineering, Dataset Engineering, Model/Harness Evaluation, AI-Enabled System Evaluation, Operational & Continuous Monitoring) – preserving the independence between builders and evaluators that NIST AI RMF and DoDI 5000.89 both require.
- **Does not unilaterally approve or deny a deployment decision.** The Board’s readiness recommendation informs the accountable business/mission owner’s decision; it is evidence, not a veto, consistent with how the Strategy’s Executive Decision capability is scoped – the Board does not become a second approval bottleneck on top of existing governance.

Scope

Every AI system evaluated under this capability: LLMs, traditional ML (translation, NER, speech, vision, forecasting, and similar), AI harnesses (agentic coding tools and similar), and AI-enabled systems (multi-component pipelines and agent workflows). Depth of Board involvement scales with the system’s Risk Tier – see the [T&E Policy](#) for the tier definitions and their mandatory gates.

Membership

5-7 voting members, seated as a standing committee from existing domain leadership – **not** new headcount:

Seat	Represents
Chair	Sponsoring executive’s designee; tie-breaking vote
LLM/agent evaluation lead	Model-layer evaluation practice

Seat	Represents
Traditional ML evaluation lead	Translation/NER/speech/vision/forecasting evaluation practice
Harness evaluation lead	AI harness (agentic tool) evaluation practice
Security lead	MITRE ATLAS-mapped risk and red-team practice
Operational test lead	OT&E-style operational evaluation practice
Metrics & Standards lead (non-voting, ex officio)	Owns the capability taxonomy and metric catalog; advises the Board but does not vote, to keep the standards-setting function separate from the standards-ratifying function

Members serve while they hold their represented role; there is no fixed term. A domain lead’s successor inherits the seat.

Decision Rights

- Standards, policy, and taxonomy changes: simple majority of voting members.
- Emergency policy exception (e.g., a Tier 1 gate cannot be met before a hard deadline): Chair may grant a time-boxed waiver, ratified retroactively by the full Board at its next meeting.
- Amendments to this Charter: two-thirds majority of voting members, plus sponsoring-executive sign-off.

Cadence

Monthly standing meeting; ad hoc for emergency waivers. Minutes and decisions are recorded in the governance audit trail alongside every other evaluated action in this capability.

Relationship to Domain Teams

Domain teams retain full technical ownership of their evaluation methodology and day-to-day work. The Board’s role is standards, registries, and reporting – not a management layer over domain teams’ existing reporting lines. This distinction is deliberate: it is the answer to the “domain teams resist consolidation” risk flagged in the Implementation Plan.

Review

This Charter is reviewed annually, or on request of two or more voting members.